

home. I managed to acquire quite a few collections which people had accumulated over a period of time,” he says.

“Indian stamps is such a vast subject that you can spend a hundred years and few hundred crore but still not cover the entire gamut,” says Kanabar who unlike his father is focussed on pre-Independence, specifically the first Indian stamps in four denominations—half anna, one anna, two anna and four anna—and archival material. Stamps were introduced in the UK in 1840 and in India in 1854. Since four anna was a large sum, the stamps were used rarely.

“Indian stamps is such a vast subject that you can spend a hundred years and few hundred crore but still not cover the entire gamut”

Kanabar has an entire album of four anna stamps with some having a market value of several thousand pounds.

Kanabar purchases his stamps particularly from auctions in the UK. London is a good hunting ground with stores like Stanley Gibbons in London’s West End. Stamps in India deteriorate because of the weather conditions. The moisture impacts them. “When you buy stamps from overseas the condition is pristine.”

Kanabar has insured his collection and keeps them in albums in an air conditioned room 24x7.

In the last five years the value of Indian stamps has boomed. Kanabar says that stamps with an estimate of £6,000 sell at auction for £35,000-40,000, with intense bidding.

“I never meant for my collection to be an investment but it has turned out to be both a hobby and an investment,” says Kanabar. **BT**

@smitabw

THE WIND IN HIS HAIR

Divide By Zero's Swapnil Sansare is passionate about exploring the country on his bike

BY NIDHI SINGAL

CEO & Founder of 3D manufacturing company Divide by Zero, Swapnil Sansare has revived his college passion of exploring India on a bike. Right after the Covid-19 pandemic restrictions were eased in Mumbai, Sansare gifted himself a Svartpilén bike from Swedish company Husqvarna, and has already completed 17 trips in less than two years. “I used to ride a bike in my college days. But once I started working I started travelling by car and air as business grew. I always missed those college-time impromptu bike rides to nearby places around Mumbai. Since the time I bought this new bike, I have explored areas around Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka and Rajasthan on my second new-found love.” His first love was the Bajaj Pulsar 150 that he rode during his college days. He rode that all the way to Kolhapur and Goa from Mumbai.

**RIDING A BIKE IS LIKE MEDITATION FOR SANSARE
“IT HELPS ME REJUVENATE TO HANDLE DAY-TO-DAY PRESSURES OF BUSINESS”**

Sansare plans a trip every month, from short weekend getaways to week-long rides. Sansare loves solo bike trips but often plans them with friends as well. One such memorable trip with his friends was in November 2021 when they rode to Chikmagalur and Coorg covering 2,100 km over seven days. “I rode from Mumbai to Kolhapur to Chikmagalur to Shimoga to Coorg to Belgaum and back to Mumbai.” Sansare says that the best part of travelling on your bike is “if you spot a perfect scenic mountain view on your way, you can park right there to capture it”.

Riding a bike is more like meditation for Sansare and taking long rides have become an important ritual in his life. “It helps me rejuvenate and return with a calm mind to handle day-to-day pressures of business.” **BT**

@nidhisigal



ON THE ROAD Sansare gifted himself a Svartpilén bike from Swedish company Husqvarna